

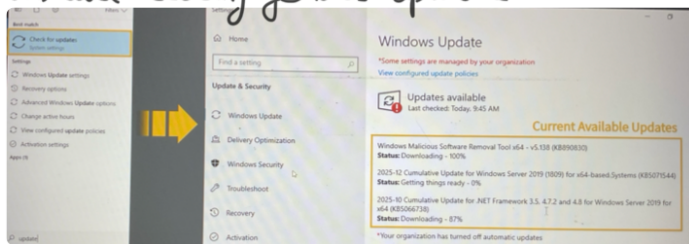
Task 3 :- Configuring and Securing windows

Updating your Applications :-

Keeping your operating system and applications up to date is an important part of maintaining a secure and stable system. updates will often include security patches, performance updates and bug fixes.

windows update :-

windows includes a built in update tool called windows update, which keeps OS and some native applications and security features up to date.



updating Applications :-

Application updates work differently depending on how software is installed.

* Built in Applications may update automatically in background.

* Third party applications often include their own update mechanisms.

* Some Applications will prompt you to update upon launch.

* Some require you to check for updates or download a new installer manually.

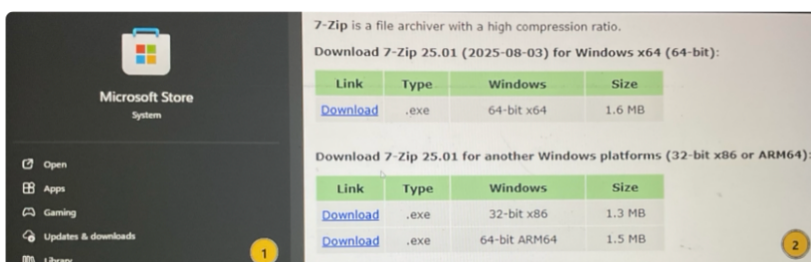
Installing Applications :-

Now let's see how updates work with windows OS and for applications.

1) Microsoft Store :- provides a curated and safe option for installing apps to windows, although it is not available by default on windows server.

2) From the Internet :- In many environments, apps are installed by downloading an installer

directly from trusted vendor's website. This usually comes in an .exe or .msi file and guide through installation process.



Installing Applications :-

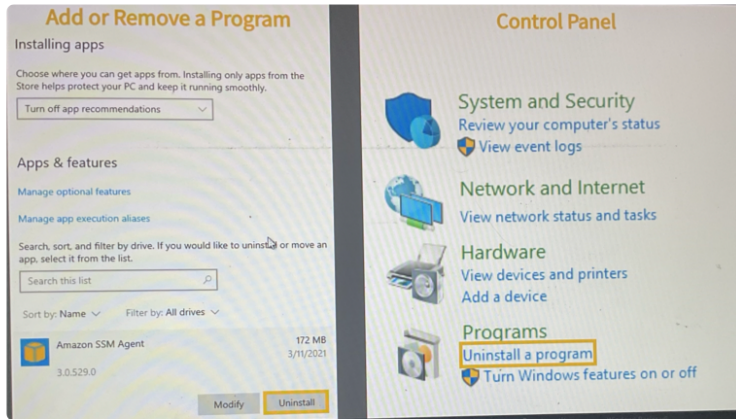
In windows environment, there are multiple ways to uninstall programs.

→ using Microsoft store for installed Applications.

→ Add or remove programs feature in System Settings

→ Uninstall a program section of Control panel.

→ using an applications built in uninstaller.



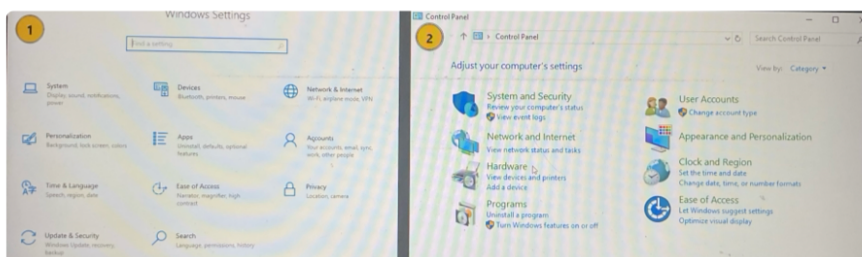
Diving Into Settings: —

There are 2 primary ways in which windows user can modify their environment.

1. windows settings: — A modern centralized location for configuring system, device, personalization and security settings in windows.

2. Control panel: — A legacy management interface that provides access to older system configuration tools. windows settings and control panel enable you to view & modify windows system operates.

From these two applications you can manage system preferences, including display and audio settings, user accounts, apps, network options, accessibility features and security configurations.



The Task Manager: —

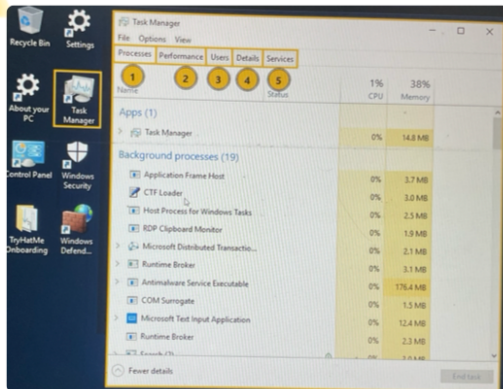
Task Manager is built in windows tool that allows you to monitor what is happening on your system real time.

It allows you to view running applications and background processes, as well as check system performance,

including CPU and memory usage. A shortcut task manager has been placed on workstation desktop.

Task Manager has 5 tabs to help you keep track of your system.

1. Processes; - Currently running apps and background processes, and their resource usage.
2. Performance; - Graphs and statistics for system resources such as CPU, memory and network.
3. Users; - Currently logged in users and used resources.
4. Details; - A more technical view of running processes, including process IDs (PIDs)
5. Services; - Windows services and their current status (running or stopped)



Native Windows Security; -

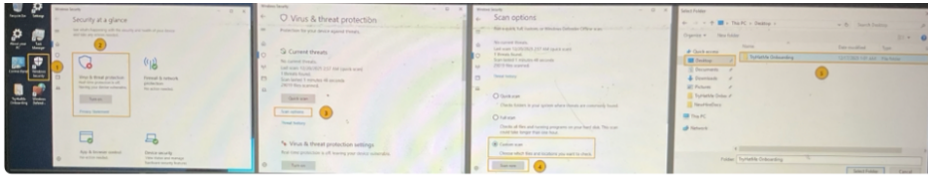
Windows offers built-in security tools designed to help protect your system from threats such as malware, insecure applications and unauthorized network access.

Windows Security; -

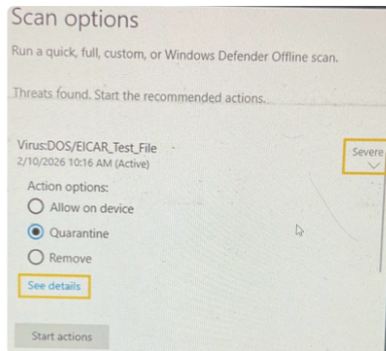
A Windows Security Application is your central dashboard for managing Windows built-in protection measures. It's divided into 4 main sections, each focusing on different security.

1. Virus and threat protection; - Helps detect and remove malicious software using real-time protection and customizable scans.
2. Firewall & network protection; - Control incoming and outgoing network traffic to help prevent unauthorized access.
3. App & browser control; - Protects users from potentially unsafe apps, files and websites.
4. Device security; - Provides hardware-based protection that helps secure the system.

1. Open Windows Security using shortcut on your Desktop.
2. Select Virus and Threat Protection Section.
3. Choose Scan options
4. Select Custom Scan, then Scan now
5. Select TryHackME onboarding folder on your Desktop as target of your scan.



your Custom Scan will have found a completely safe test file, and this process shows how Windows is capable of scanning for and detecting threats. Keep in mind that this is just one aspect of security measures Windows has in place to help secure your system. Go ahead and click See details to investigate the file and answer final question on task.



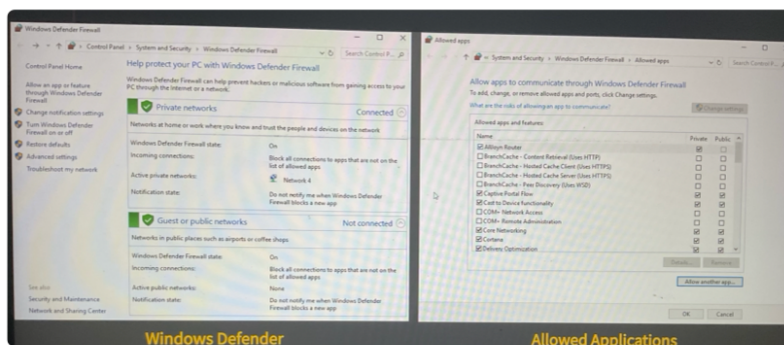
Windows Defender Firewall :-

Windows Defender Firewall is built in firewall designed to help protect your computer from unauthorized network traffic. It monitors network connections and applies rules that determine whether connections are allowed or denied. The firewall operates on different network profiles, allowing you to create custom rules or specify applications that are permitted.

* Domain :- used when a system is connected to an organization's domain network

* Private :- Intended for trusted networks, such as home or lab environment.

* Public :- used for untrusted networks, such as public wifi.



Checking Advanced Settings of Windows Defender Firewall, you can view.

1. An overview of your firewall inbound, outbound and connection rules.

1. Overview of your previous settings, including rule creation, status and action.

2. A detailed view of each rule, including name, group, network profile, status and action.

3. Create new rules & filter your current view.

